DAY 24 | POST-READ

Influence and Orchestration: Recap and Beyond

What we covered today, plus ideas to keep developing.

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Part A: Summary of today

Topic	What to remember
Influence	Credibility, logic, connection. Frame the same truth for each stakeholder.
Positions vs interests	Ask why. Interests open up options that positions hide.
BATNA	Your best alternative if no agreement. Know it before you negotiate.
Conflict styles	Collaborate, compromise, compete, accommodate, avoid. Choose deliberately.
De-escalation	Pause, acknowledge, ask, restate, agree a small next step.
LangChain LCEL	prompt | model | parser. invoke, batch, stream.
RAG chain	{context: retriever, question: passthrough} | prompt | model | parser.
Routing	Classify first, then send to the right chain (RunnableBranch).
Coding agents	Small scoped tasks, pointers to files and commands, AGENTS.md, tests, review every diff.

Part B: Going beyond today

1. Pre-wiring decisions

Before an important meeting, talk to key people one by one. Nobody likes surprises in front of their boss. Meetings then confirm decisions rather than fight over them.

2. Structured output with Pydantic

```
class Expense(BaseModel):
    employee: str
    amount: float
    currency: str

structured = ChatOpenAI(model=MODEL).with_structured_output(Expense)
```

with_structured_output asks the model for data matching your schema and returns a validated object.

3. Tracing

Tracing tools record every step of a chain: inputs, outputs, latency and tokens. When an answer is wrong, you can see whether retrieval or generation failed.

4. Frameworks are optional

For a single prompt, plain API calls are simpler. Use a framework when composition, swapping providers or ready-made integrations save real effort. Understand what it does under the hood either way.

5. AGENTS.md

Codex and several other coding agents read an AGENTS.md file in the repository for project instructions: how to run tests, code style, folders to avoid. It doubles as onboarding notes for humans.

Part C: Reflect

- Which conflict style do you use by habit? When did it not serve you?
- Write the BATNA for a negotiation you expect this month.
- Which part of today's chains would you trace first if answers were wrong?
- What should every coding agent brief include?

Part D: Practice ideas for tonight

- Add a structured output chain that extracts action items from meeting notes.
- Write an AGENTS.md for your Task Board repository.
- Prepare a one-page negotiation plan for a scope discussion in your project.

Coming up on Day 25: tool calling, LangGraph workflows and a systems thinking activity, plus one-on-one feedback.

Otsukaresama deshita (お疲れ様でした): thank you for your hard work today